



AI, Edge, and Identity

will.i.am and Qualcomm's bold vision for tomorrow's cars and creators

It's not every day that a technology-driven artist teams up with a global chipmaking powerhouse to redefine the future of mobility, AI, and media. But when will.i.am, the creative artist and founder of FYI.AI, joined Don McGuire, Senior Vice President and CMO of Qualcomm, on the sidelines of the Snapdragon Auto Day 2025 in India, the conversation wasn't just about entertainment; it was about infrastructure, about the digital chassis and about Snapdragon powering the future of automotive industry.

This wasn't a pitch for gadgets. It was a glimpse into a world where intelligence lives on the edge, not in

the cloud. And India, they both agreed, may be the ultimate proving ground for that vision.

Why Snapdragon's Edge AI could transform Indian roads

The conversation began with will.i.am marvelling at Indian traffic: cows sharing space with sedans, people flowing through seemingly chaotic intersections. To many, it's a disorder, to Qualcomm, it's data that's rich in real-world variability; one that demands smarter, more adaptive AI models.

Snapdragon's automotive platforms are built for that kind of complexity. Don McGuire emphasised Qualcomm's full-stack approach: "We're

not just selling chips. We're building scalable solutions, from connectivity to compute to driver assistance."

Qualcomm's differentiation, he said, is in how they treat the car as a software-defined platform, where intelligence isn't patched in later but designed from the ground up.

Snapdragon Ride, for instance, isn't simply an ADAS solution. It's a core building block in Qualcomm's Digital Chassis, a modular architecture that can scale from two-wheelers to luxury sedans and everything in between.

From silicon to soul: Partnering to build intelligent media

will.i.am's FYI RAiDiO, which is now running on Snapdragon platforms, is a case study in how Qualcomm enables creativity at the edge. It's not just a futuristic radio; it's a reimagined media system that blends AI with human curation, and it does it all while operating locally to preserve privacy.

FYI RAiDiO's architecture leverages Qualcomm's on-device compute power to run conversational agents without sending sensitive data to the cloud. "Your AI shouldn't be a village tool," will.i.am said. "It should live with you. Learn from you. And stay yours." Qualcomm's edge-first approach makes that not only possible, but scalable.

The partnership was formalised in March at SXSW. Within weeks, Snapdragon was powering both FYI RAiDiO and FYI SoundDrive, an interactive music remixing platform that reacts to vehicle telemetry in real time. From ideation to implementation, under 6 months. "That's not common at our scale," Don noted. "We move like a startup. It's part of our DNA."

"We went from a handshake in January to a chip on Snapdragon by July. That's Qualcomm for you," said will.i.am, on the speed of executing the Qualcomm-FYI partnership.

The digital chassis: A platform, not just a part

What sets Snapdragon apart isn't